Ashrama (stages of life): in mainstream orthodox Hinduism, the ideal life of a member of one of the three higher castes comprises four stages: celibate studentship (*brahmacarya*); householder (*grihastha*); forest dweller (*vanaprastha*); world renouncer (*samnyasin*). The householder is pivotal in the world of ordinary social relations. He generates wealth, provides for the family and pays for rituals that keep the world going. The practice of world renunciation (***samnyasa***) may have begun as the abdication of such responsibilities. (*Gautama* the *Buddha* and his followers are a case of men who have gone from home to homelessness.) Accordingly, orthodoxy accommodated renunciation by placing it at the end of life.

Further reading: Olivelle 1993

Asiddha-hetu (unestablished logical reason): one of the varieties of bogus reason (***hetvabhasa***) making an inference defective. It occurs when the logical reason does not occur in the subject (***paksha***) under consideration (*svarupa-asiddhi*); for example, 'sound is a property, because it is visible', and in cases where the subject of the inference does not exist or when its existence is controversial (*ashraya-asiddhi*). Buddhists apply this to what are held by Hindus to be proofs of the existence of the soul and its properties. They say that no soul is perceived apart from experiences, and, since it is the sort of thing that ought to be perceptible, its existence cannot be proved.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Potter and Bhattacharya 1993; Tillemans 1999

Atman (enduring soul/self): there is a widespread Hindu (and ***Jaina***) conviction that our experience of ourselves as the same individual is due to an unchanging non-physical and eternal factor over and above the stream of experiences making up embodied personality. The majority view is